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When Did We Become Roommates?

Reconnect with the person sleeping next
to you — before the silence wins.

You're not fighting. You've just gone quiet.

You share a bed, a calendar, a kitchen — and not much else. Conversations are logistics. Evenings are two phones on one couch. You're not angry; you're just... roommates who used to be in love. And the scariest part is how normal it feels.

Disconnection is rarely a dramatic event. It's a slow drift — and it's reversible. This isn't about blame or a 50-step program. It's small, proven habits that quietly pull two people back toward each other.

ONE HONEST NOTE

This is for a tired, distant, "we lost each other" marriage — not for abuse or contempt. If you feel unsafe or constantly torn down, please talk to a professional.

STEP 1

Name the drift

You can't reconnect what you won't look at. Quietly tick what's gone missing — no blame, just honesty:

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Real conversation (beyond logistics) | ☐ Physical intimacy |
| ☐ Everyday affection / touch | ☐ Knowing what's going on in their inner world |
| ☐ Laughing together | ☐ Feeling like a team, not a to-do list |
| ☐ Feeling seen and appreciated | ☐ Curiosity about each other |
| ☐ Shared fun or adventure | ☐ Time that isn't kids/work/chores |

What I miss most about "us":

STEP 2

Small habits, big reconnection

You don't need a second honeymoon. Research shows tiny, repeated moments rebuild closeness fastest. Start one today:

- **The 6-second kiss.** Long enough to feel something. Once a day, hello or goodbye. (Yes, it's awkward at first. Do it anyway.)
- **The phones-down hour.** One hour, no screens, in the same room. Presence is the whole point.
- **The 20-minute check-in.** Sit, no agenda, and actually talk — not about the kids or the calendar.
- **Daily appreciation.** Name one specific thing you're grateful for about them, out loud.

Pick ONE this week. Connection isn't rebuilt in a grand gesture — it's rebuilt in repeated small turns toward each other.

STEP 3

Ask better questions

"How was your day?" gets "fine." Real questions reopen the door. Try one over dinner this week:

- What's something you're looking forward to lately?

- When did you feel closest to me recently?

- What's been weighing on you that I might not know about?

- What's one thing I could do that would make you feel loved this week?

- If we had a free weekend, no kids, what would you want to do?

- What do you miss about how we used to be?

STEP 4

Turn toward the small bids

All day, your partner makes tiny "bids" for attention — a sigh, a comment, "look at this." Relationships are made or broken by how often you *turn toward* them instead of away.

- **Notice the bids.** "Ugh, long day" is a bid. So is "the sunset's nice."
- **Turn toward.** Look up. Respond. Even a "tell me about it" counts hugely.
- **Catch yourself turning away.** Phone, "mm-hm," changing the subject — those add up too.
- **Make your own bids.** Reach out first. Vulnerability invites it back.

One bid from my partner I'll make sure to turn toward this week:

STEP 5

Protect a weekly "us"

What gets scheduled survives. Put your marriage on the calendar like it matters — because it does:

- **A real date.** Out or in — cheap counts. The rule: no kids, no logistics talk.
- **A 15-minute "state of us."** What went well, what felt off, one thing to try next week.
- **A shared something.** A show, a walk, a project — one thing that's just yours together.
- **Touch on purpose.** A hand, a hug hello, sitting close. Affection without it leading anywhere.

Our weekly "us" time will be:

REMEMBER

You can find your way back.

Read it when the distance feels permanent. It isn't:

- Drifting apart is common — and reversible.
- Small, consistent turns beat one grand gesture.
- I can reach for them first without keeping score.
- "Roommates" is a season, not a sentence.
- The person I fell for is still in there — and so am I.

The one small thing I'll start this week:

You didn't fall out of love. You fell out of practice.

One kiss, one question, one hour with the phones down.
Reconnection is built in the small turns toward each other —
starting tonight, on that same couch.

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